

A Lamp on a Stand

LET YOUR LIGHT SHINE

True faith is meant to be seen — for the glory of God.



SCRIPTURE REFERENCES

Matthew 5:14–16

Mark 4:21–22

Luke 8:16–17; 11:33–36



THE STORY

Jesus said that no one lights a lamp and puts it under a bowl. Instead, they put it on a stand, so that it gives light to everyone in the house. In the same way, our good deeds should be seen by others, so that they may see our good works and give glory to our Father in heaven.

(Matthew 5:14–16)

A lamp is meant to give light. Hiding it defeats its purpose. Jesus calls his followers to live openly as people of light in a dark world.



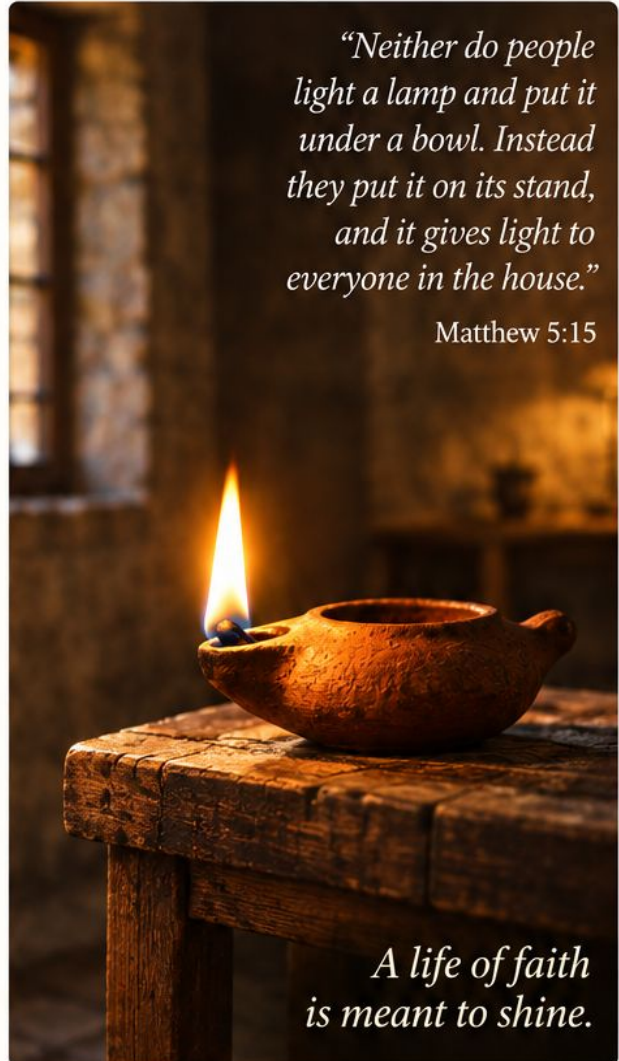
KEY LESSONS

- Our faith is meant to be visible, not hidden.
- Good works are the natural fruit of true faith.
- Others see God through our consistent obedience.
- We are called to influence our homes, workplaces, and communities for his glory.
- Hiding our faith denies the purpose of the light we've been given.



HOW TO APPLY

- Let your Christian life be seen in everyday situations.
- Look for opportunities to love and serve others.
- Don't hide your faith out of fear or comfort.
- Ask God to help you be a light where you live, work, and play.
- Give him the glory, not yourself.



"Neither do people light a lamp and put it under a bowl. Instead they put it on its stand, and it gives light to everyone in the house."

Matthew 5:15

A life of faith is meant to shine.



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

You were created to make a difference for God's glory.

"Let your light shine before others, so that they may see your good works and give glory to your Father who is in heaven."

MATTHEW 5:16

SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.

The Wise and Foolish Builders

BUILD YOUR LIFE ON A SURE FOUNDATION



SCRIPTURE REFERENCES

Matthew 7:24–27
Luke 6:47–49



THE STORY

Jesus told of two men who built houses. One built his house on the rock. The other built his house on sand. When the rains came, the floods rose, and the winds blew and beat against the houses, the house on the rock stood firm. But the house on the sand fell with a great crash.



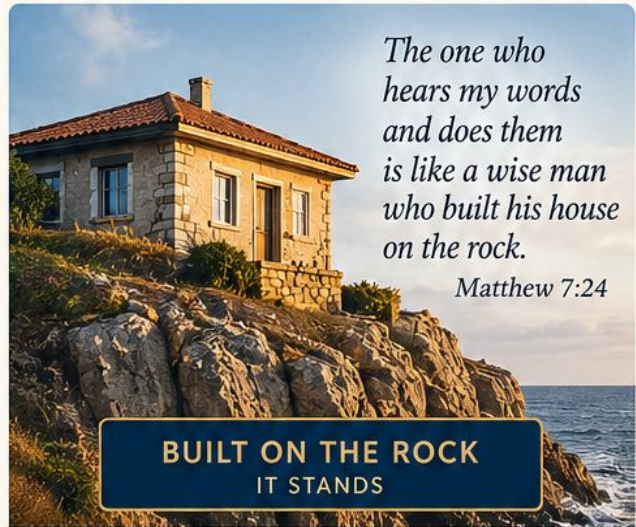
KEY LESSONS

- Hearing Jesus' words is not enough — we must do them.
- Obedience to Christ is the foundation for a stable life.
- Trials and storms will come, but a life built on Jesus will stand.
- A superficial faith cannot withstand the challenges of life.



HOW TO APPLY

- Build your life on the teachings of Jesus through obedience.
- Make the Bible the foundation for your decisions, values, and actions.
- Examine your life: is it built on the rock or on shifting sand?
- Start today to put Jesus' words into practice.



The one who hears my words and does them is like a wise man who built his house on the rock.

Matthew 7:24

BUILT ON THE ROCK
IT STANDS



The one who hears my words and does not do them is like a foolish man who built his house on the sand.

Matthew 7:26

BUILT ON THE SAND
IT FALLS



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

It's not what you hear that saves you — it's what you do.

"Everyone then who hears these words of mine and does them will be like a wise man who built his house on the rock."

MATTHEW 7:24

SAME
TRUTH.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.

New Cloth on an Old Garment

SOME THINGS DON'T FIT TOGETHER



SCRIPTURE REFERENCES

Matthew 9:16

Mark 2:21

Luke 5:36



THE STORY

Jesus said, "No one sews a piece of new cloth on an old garment, for the patch pulls away from the garment, making the tear worse. And no one puts new wine into old wineskins." (Matthew 9:16)

Jesus was teaching that the new work of the Kingdom cannot be forced into old religious systems. The old and the new do not fit together.



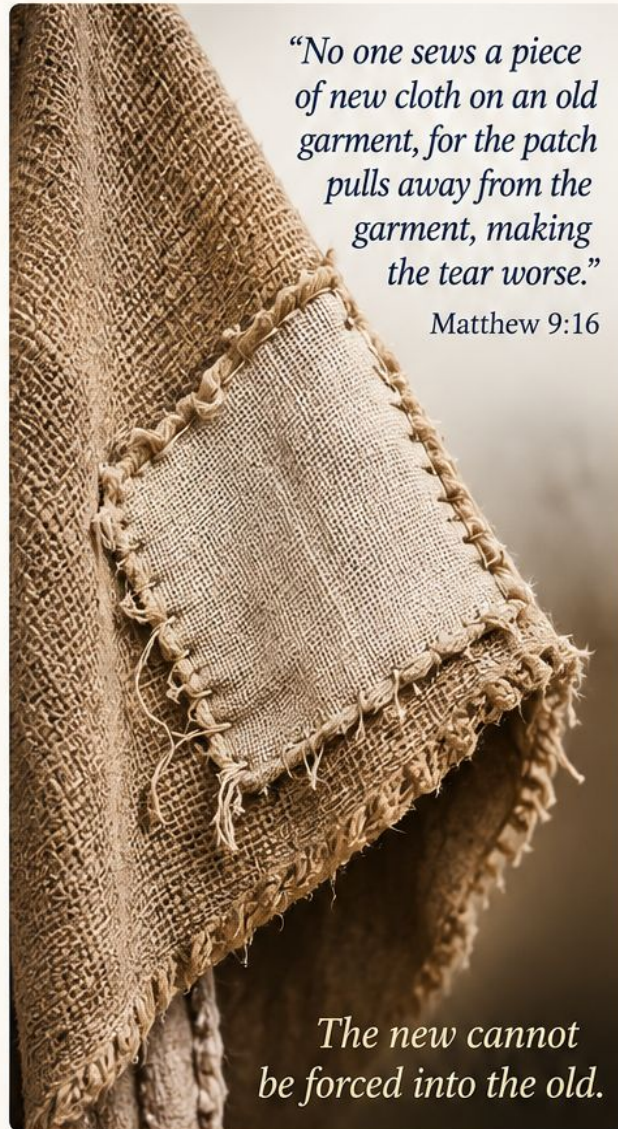
KEY LESSONS

- The message and mission of Jesus are new, not a minor adjustment to the old.
- Trying to mix the old and the new creates greater problems.
- True change requires a transformed heart, not a patch on an old life.
- The Kingdom of God brings a fresh way of living, not just religious ritual.



HOW TO APPLY

- Don't try to live the Christian life by old patterns and self-effort.
- Embrace the new life in Christ through faith and the work of the Spirit.
- Be open to God's transforming work, even when it requires letting go of old habits and systems.
- Cultivate a heart that is new, not just outward religious change.



"No one sews a piece of new cloth on an old garment, for the patch pulls away from the garment, making the tear worse."

Matthew 9:16

The new cannot be forced into the old.



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

A new Kingdom requires a new heart.

"No one who puts a hand to the plow and looks back is fit for the Kingdom of God."

LUKE 9:62

NEW
LIVES.
BRIGHTER
TOMORROWS.

New Wine in Old Wineskins

FRESH WINE REQUIRES A FRESH CONTAINER



SCRIPTURE REFERENCES

Matthew 9:17
Mark 2:22
Luke 5:37–38



THE STORY

Jesus said, “No one pours new wine into old wineskins. If he does, the wine will burst the skins, and both the wine and the wineskins will be ruined. Instead, new wine must be poured into new wineskins.” (Luke 5:37–38)

Jesus was teaching that the new work of the Kingdom cannot be confined to old religious forms. The new wine represents the new life and new teaching Jesus brings, which requires new hearts and fresh ways of living.



KEY LESSONS

- The Kingdom of God brings something new, not a small improvement to the old.
- Old religious systems cannot contain the new life Jesus brings.
- God’s truth requires hearts that are flexible and responsive.
- We must be open to the transforming work of Christ, not clinging to old forms and traditions.



HOW TO APPLY

- Be willing to let go of old habits that hinder your growth in Christ.
- Embrace the new life Jesus offers through faith and the work of the Spirit.
- Examine whether you are trying to put new wine into old wineskins.
- Cultivate a teachable heart, ready for God to do a new work in you.

“No one pours new wine into old wineskins. If he does, the wine will burst the skins, and both the wine and the wineskins will be ruined. Instead, new wine must be poured into new wineskins.”

Luke 5:37–38



New life needs new hearts.



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

God’s new wine will always require new wineskins.

“Therefore, if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away; behold, the new has come.”

2 CORINTHIANS 5:17

NEW
HEARTS.
NEW LIVES.
A BRIGHTER
TOMORROW.

The Sower

THE CONDITION OF OUR HEARTS MATTERS



SCRIPTURE REFERENCES

Matthew 13:3–9

Mark 4:2–9

Luke 8:4–8



THE STORY

Jesus told a farmer who went out to sow seed. As he scattered the seed, some fell on the path, some on rocky ground, some among thorns, and some on good soil. The seed that fell on good soil produced a crop, some a hundredfold, some sixty, and some thirty. Then Jesus said, “Whoever has ears, let them hear.” (Matthew 13:3–9)



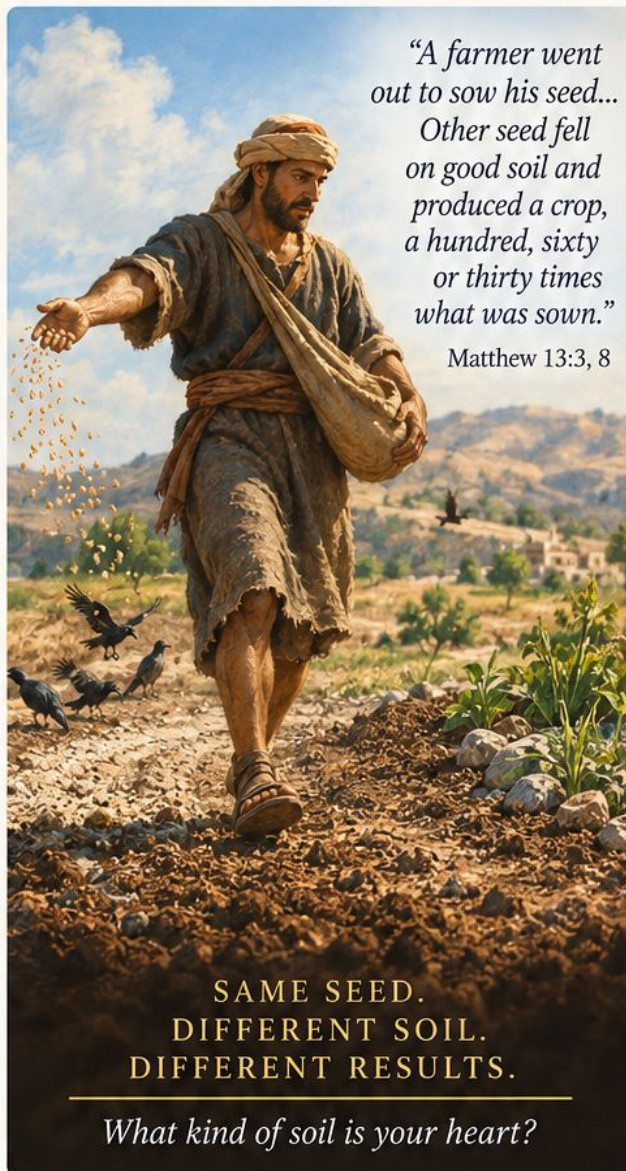
KEY LESSONS

- The same seed (God’s Word) goes everywhere, but the results depend on the condition of the heart.
- A closed heart rejects the Word.
- A shallow heart receives it with joy but does not endure.
- A distracted heart allows the cares of this world to choke it.
- A good and receptive heart bears fruit for God’s glory.



HOW TO APPLY

- Examine your heart regularly — What kind of soil am I?
- Remove the “rocks” of shallow commitment.
- Root out the “thorns” of worldly distractions.
- Cultivate a heart that hears, understands, and obeys God’s Word.



“A farmer went out to sow his seed... Other seed fell on good soil and produced a crop, a hundred, sixty or thirty times what was sown.”

Matthew 13:3, 8

**SAME SEED.
DIFFERENT SOIL.
DIFFERENT RESULTS.**

What kind of soil is your heart?



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

God’s Word always bears fruit in a receptive heart.

“But as for what was sown on good soil, this is the one who hears the word and understands it, who indeed bears fruit and yields, in one case a hundredfold, in another sixty, and in another thirty.”

MATTHEW 13:23

**SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.**

The Weeds

GOOD AND EVIL GROW TOGETHER

Be patient. God will make the final separation.



SCRIPTURE REFERENCE

Matthew 13:24–30, 36–43



THE STORY

Jesus told a parable about a man who sowed good seed in his field. While everyone was sleeping, his enemy came and sowed weeds among the wheat. When the plants grew, the weeds appeared as well. The servants asked if they should pull up the weeds, but the owner said, “No, let both grow together until the harvest. At that time I will tell the harvesters, ‘First collect the weeds and tie them in bundles to be burned, but gather the wheat into my barn.’” (Matthew 13:24–30)



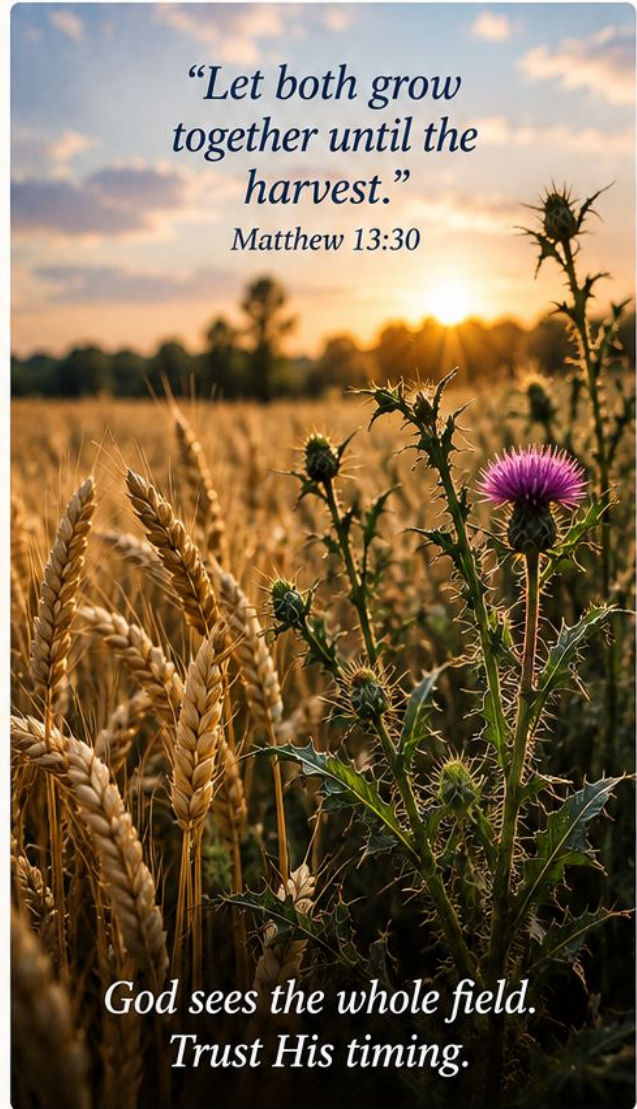
KEY LESSONS

- Good and evil both exist in the world and even within the visible church.
- We are called to be faithful, not to take final judgment into our own hands.
- God is patient and gives time for repentance.
- There will be a final separation at the return of Christ.
- Our focus is to grow as faithful wheat and shine for His glory.



HOW TO APPLY

- Be patient when you see evil or hypocrisy.
- Leave final judgment to God.
- Stay faithful and keep growing in Christ.
- Encourage other believers and point people to Jesus.
- Trust that God will make all things right in the end.



“Let both grow together until the harvest.”

Matthew 13:30

*God sees the whole field.
Trust His timing.*



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

Your job is to be faithful wheat, not to pull weeds.

*“The harvest is the end of the age,
and the harvesters are angels.”*

MATTHEW 13:39

SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.

The Mustard Seed

SMALL BEGINNINGS. A GREAT KINGDOM.

God often uses what looks small to accomplish something great.



SCRIPTURE REFERENCES

Matthew 13:31–32
Mark 4:30–32
Luke 13:18–19



THE STORY

Jesus said, “The kingdom of heaven is like a mustard seed, which a man took and sowed in his field. Though it is the smallest of all seeds, yet when it grows, it is the largest of garden plants and becomes a tree, so that the birds come and perch in its branches.” (Matthew 13:31–32)

Jesus used a tiny seed — familiar to His audience — to show how the Kingdom of God often starts small but grows into something large and life-giving.



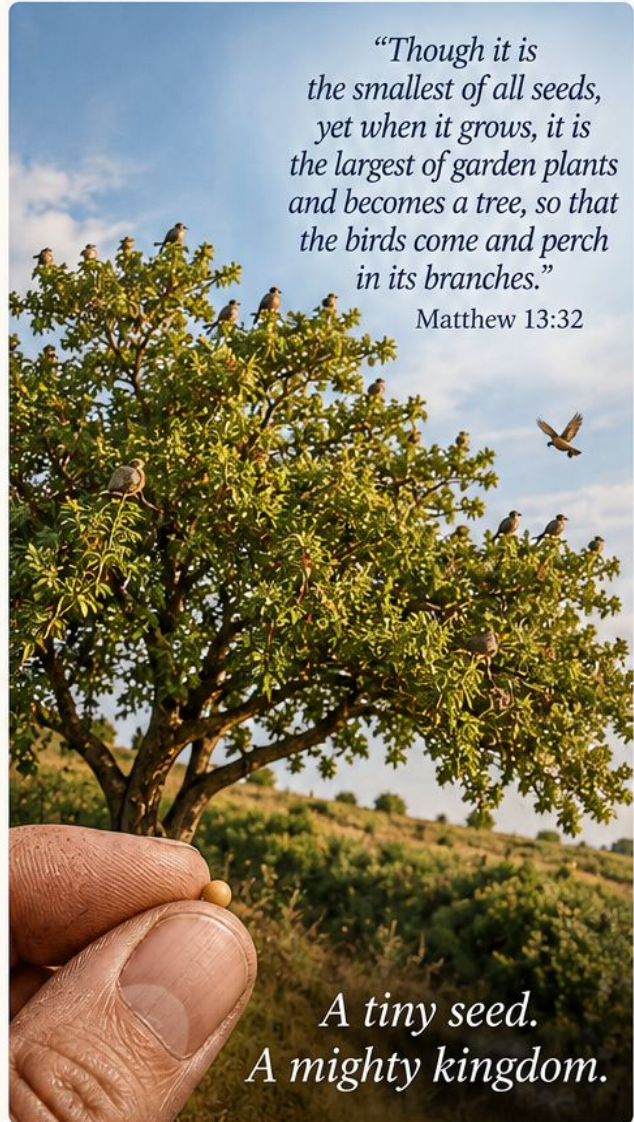
KEY LESSONS

- God’s Kingdom often begins in humble and unseen ways.
- Small obedience can lead to significant, lasting fruit.
- God uses ordinary people and ordinary means to accomplish extraordinary purposes.
- The Kingdom grows beyond our expectations and provides shelter for many.
- We are called to faithfulness in the small, trusting God for the growth.



HOW TO APPLY

- Do not despise small beginnings.
- Be faithful in the opportunities God has given you, even if they seem small.
- Trust God to bring growth in His time.
- Look for ways to be a place of blessing and refuge for others.
- Keep sowing the seed of God’s Word in your home, church, and community.



“Though it is the smallest of all seeds, yet when it grows, it is the largest of garden plants and becomes a tree, so that the birds come and perch in its branches.”

Matthew 13:32

*A tiny seed.
A mighty kingdom.*



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

God’s Kingdom often starts small, but it never stays small.

“If you have faith as small as a mustard seed, you can say to this mountain, ‘Move from here to there,’ and it will move.”

MATTHEW 17:20

SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.

The Yeast

A SMALL INFLUENCE MAKES A BIG DIFFERENCE

The Gospel quietly works, but powerfully spreads.



SCRIPTURE REFERENCES

Matthew 13:33
Luke 13:20–21



THE STORY

Jesus said, “The kingdom of heaven is like yeast that a woman took and mixed into about sixty pounds of flour until it worked all through the dough.”
(Matthew 13:33)

Again He said, “What shall I compare the kingdom of God to? It is like yeast that a woman took and mixed into about sixty pounds of flour until it worked all through the dough.”
(Luke 13:20–21)

A small amount of yeast, hidden in the dough, gradually and completely works through the whole batch, changing it from the inside out.



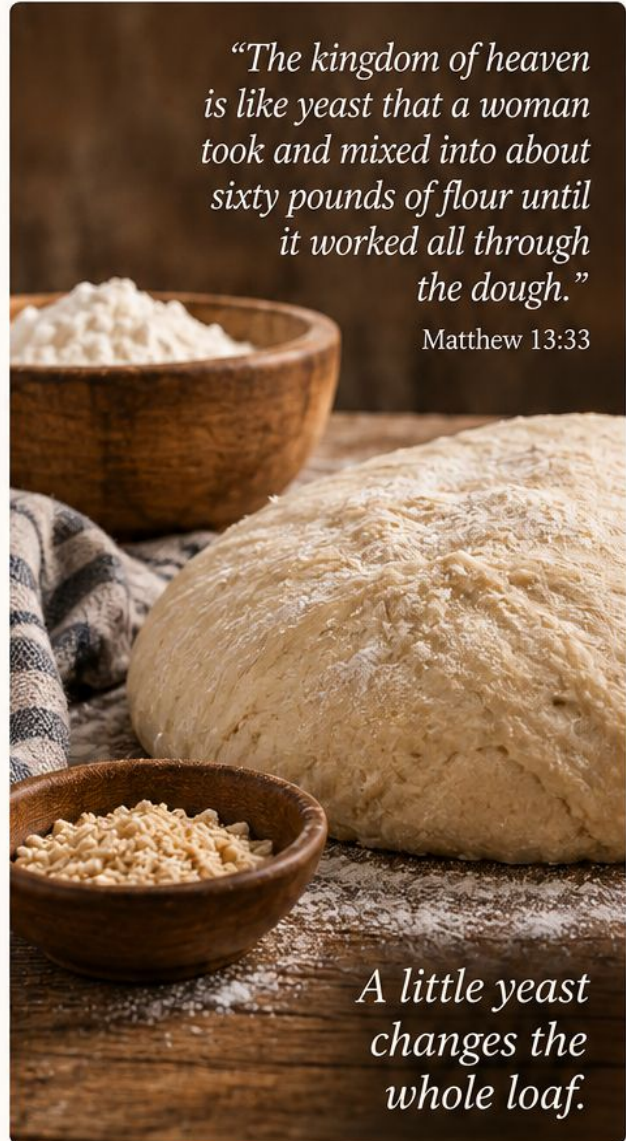
KEY LESSONS

- The Kingdom of God often starts small, but it grows steadily and extensively.
- God’s work is usually quiet, patient, and internal.
- A small influence can transform a whole community or culture.
- We are called to be faithful in the small things, trusting God for the increase.
- The Gospel changes hearts from the inside out.



HOW TO APPLY

- Don’t be discouraged by small beginnings.
- Be faithful to live out Christ in your daily life.
- Look for opportunities to influence your family, neighborhood, and workplace.
- Trust God to use your faithfulness, even when the results are not immediately visible.
- Pray for the quiet, unseen work of the Gospel to spread in your community and culture.



“The kingdom of heaven is like yeast that a woman took and mixed into about sixty pounds of flour until it worked all through the dough.”

Matthew 13:33

A little yeast changes the whole loaf.



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

Small faithfulness, used by God, can change the world.

“The kingdom of God is not a matter of talk, but of power.”

1 CORINTHIANS 4:20

SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.

The Hidden Treasure

GREAT VALUE IS WORTH WHOLEHEARTED COMMITMENT

When you find what is truly valuable, you give everything for it.



SCRIPTURE REFERENCE

Matthew 13:44



THE STORY

Jesus said, "The kingdom of heaven is like treasure hidden in a field, which a man found and covered up. Then in his joy he goes and sells all that he has and buys that field." (Matthew 13:44)

A man unexpectedly discovers a treasure hidden in a field. Realizing its great value, he hides it again, goes and sells everything he has, and buys the field so the treasure can be his.



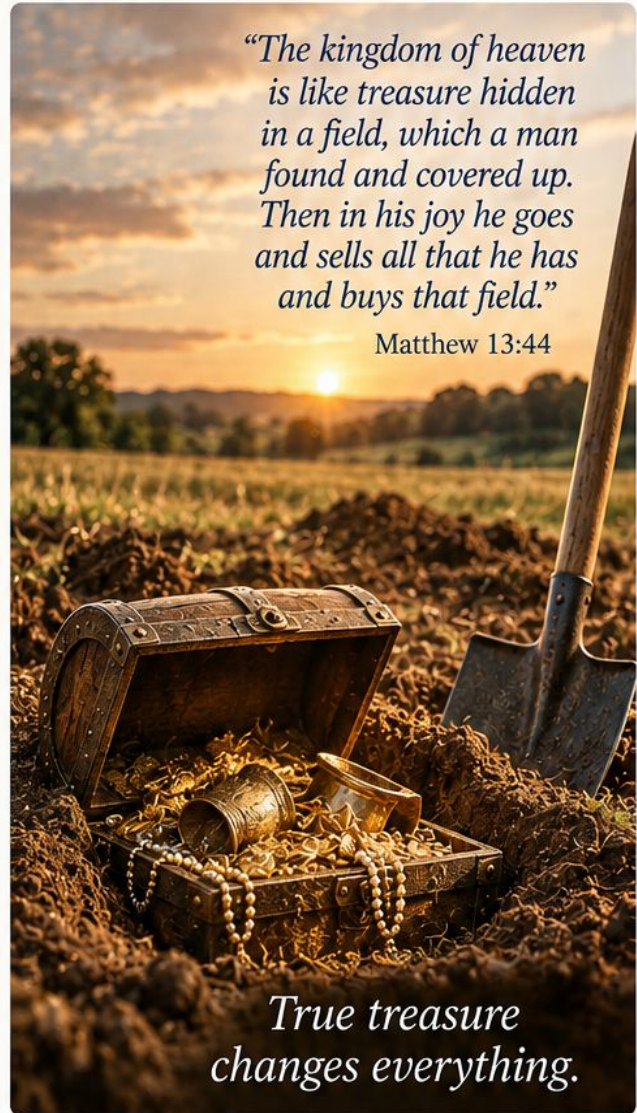
KEY LESSONS

- The Kingdom of God is of incomparable value.
- True treasure is worth any cost.
- Finding Christ brings great joy and radical commitment.
- The world's possessions pale in comparison to knowing Jesus.
- Salvation is not a casual decision but a wholehearted surrender.



HOW TO APPLY

- Recognize the supreme value of knowing Jesus and His Kingdom.
- Be willing to let go of lesser treasures that compete for your heart.
- Count the cost and follow Christ fully.
- Live with eternal perspective.
- Cultivate joy in what God has given you in Christ.



"The kingdom of heaven is like treasure hidden in a field, which a man found and covered up. Then in his joy he goes and sells all that he has and buys that field."

Matthew 13:44

True treasure changes everything.



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

When you find the Kingdom of God, you will find it is worth everything.

"For where your treasure is, there your heart will be also."

MATTHEW 6:21

SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.

The Pearl

GREAT CHOICES REFLECT GREAT VALUE

True worth is recognized — and pursued.



SCRIPTURE REFERENCES

Matthew 13:45–46



THE STORY

Again, the kingdom of heaven is like a merchant in search of fine pearls. When he found one pearl of great value, he went away and sold everything he had and bought it.” (Matthew 13:45–46)

A merchant was looking for the very best pearl. When he found a pearl of extraordinary value, he recognized its worth and immediately sold all that he had in order to buy it.



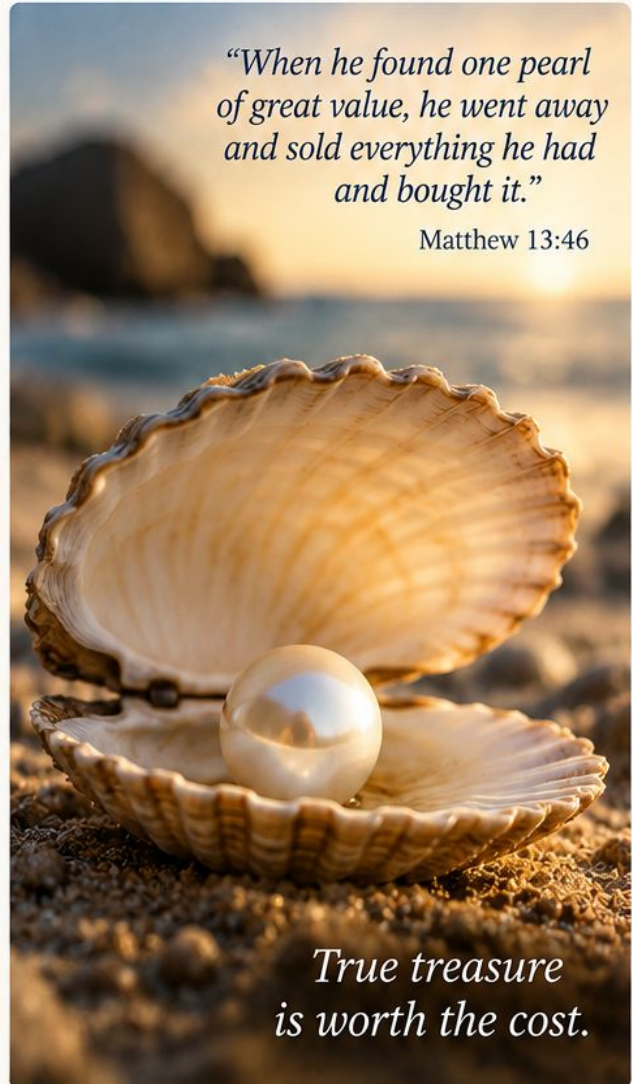
KEY LESSONS

- The Kingdom of God is of incomparable value.
- Recognizing true worth requires spiritual discernment.
- Following Christ may call for radical sacrifice.
- What we gain in Christ is infinitely greater than what we give up.
- Eternal treasure outweighs temporary possessions.



HOW TO APPLY

- Examine what you truly value.
- Be willing to let go of lesser things.
- Seek the Kingdom of God with deliberate purpose.
- Make choices today that reflect eternal priorities.
- Remember: following Jesus is not a loss, but a gain beyond compare.



“When he found one pearl of great value, he went away and sold everything he had and bought it.”

Matthew 13:46

True treasure is worth the cost.



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

The Kingdom of God is the greatest treasure you will ever find.

“For where your treasure is, there your heart will be also.”

MATTHEW 6:21

SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.

The Net

A WIDE GATHERING. A FINAL SEPARATION.

The Kingdom brings many in — and one day there will be a sorting.



SCRIPTURE REFERENCE

Matthew 13:47–50



THE STORY

Jesus said, “The kingdom of heaven is like a net that was thrown into the sea and gathered fish of every kind. When it was full, the fishermen pulled it ashore and sat down and sorted the good into containers but threw away the bad. So it will be at the end of the age. The angels will come and separate the evil from the righteous and throw them into the blazing furnace, where there will be weeping and gnashing of teeth.” (Matthew 13:47–50)

The net gathers a great number, but there is a final separation. Not everyone who is near the Kingdom truly belongs to it.



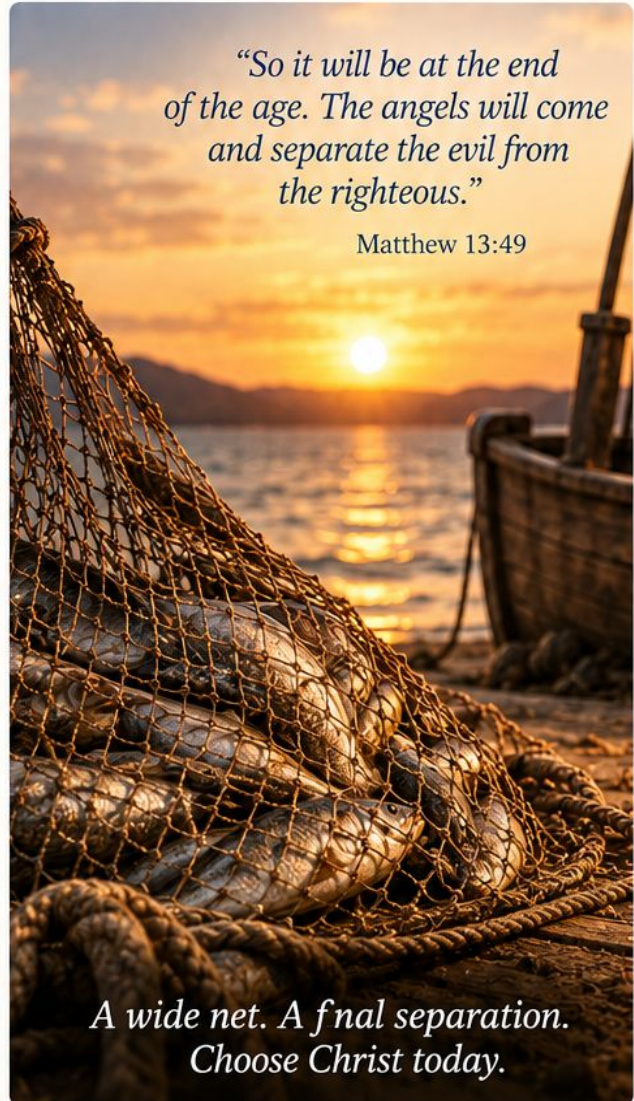
KEY LESSONS

- The Gospel goes out widely, gathering people from every kind of background.
- Not everyone who is included outwardly is truly transformed inwardly.
- There will be a final judgment and separation.
- God sees the heart, not just external association.
- We are called to examine ourselves and live with eternal perspective.



HOW TO APPLY

- Don't assume that being “in” the church means you are truly in the Kingdom.
- Examine your heart and respond to Christ in genuine faith.
- Share the Gospel widely — it's for everyone.
- Live a life that bears the fruit of true discipleship.
- Be ready for the day when Christ returns.



“So it will be at the end of the age. The angels will come and separate the evil from the righteous.”

Matthew 13:49

*A wide net. A final separation.
Choose Christ today.*



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

The Gospel gathers many, but only those who truly belong to Christ will remain.

“Enter through the narrow gate, for wide is the gate and broad is the road that leads to destruction.”

MATTHEW 7:13

SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.

The Ten Virgins

BE READY. THE KING WILL COME.

True disciples live in faithful readiness, not careless delay.



SCRIPTURE REFERENCES

Matthew 25:1–13



THE STORY

Jesus said, “The kingdom of heaven will be like ten virgins who took their lamps and went out to meet the bridegroom. Five of them were foolish and five were wise. The foolish took their lamps but did not take any oil with them. The wise, however, took oil in jars along with their lamps.

The bridegroom was a long time in coming, and they all became drowsy and fell asleep. But at midnight a cry rang out: ‘Here’s the bridegroom! Come out to meet him!’ Then all the virgins woke up and trimmed their lamps. The foolish said to the wise, ‘Give us some of your oil.’ But the wise replied, ‘No, there may not be enough for both us and you. Instead, go to those who sell oil and buy some for yourselves.’

“Therefore keep watch, because you do not know the day or the hour.”
(Matthew 25:1–13)



KEY LESSONS

- The Kingdom requires personal readiness.
- True faith is more than a profession — it is a prepared life.
- Spiritual complacency is dangerous.
- We cannot borrow true faith from others.
- Christ will return, and we must be ready.



HOW TO APPLY

- Take your walk with Christ seriously.
- Cultivate faith daily through prayer and Scripture.
- Do not be spiritually careless or distracted by the world.
- Encourage others to be ready.
- Live each day in light of Christ’s return.



*“Therefore keep watch,
because you do not know
the day or the hour.”*

Matthew 25:13

*Be ready.
The King is coming.*



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

*Readiness today
brings joy tomorrow.*

*“Therefore you also must be ready, for the Son of Man
is coming at an hour you do not expect.”*

MATTHEW 24:44

SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.

The Talents

FAITHFUL STEWARDSHIP WHILE WE WAIT

What you do with what you've been given matters.



SCRIPTURE REFERENCES

Matthew 25:14–30



THE STORY

Jesus said, “For it is like a man going on a journey, who called his servants and entrusted his wealth to them. To one he gave five talents, to another two, and to another one, to each according to his ability. Then he went on his journey. The man who had received five talents went at once and traded with them, and he made five talents more. So also the one with two talents made two more. But the man who had received one talent went and dug in the ground and hid his master’s money. After a long time the master returned and settled accounts with them.” (Matthew 25:14–19)

Each servant was accountable for how he used what was entrusted to him. The two faithful servants were commended. The unfaithful servant was condemned for wastefulness and fear. (Matthew 25:20–30)



KEY LESSONS

- Everything we have is entrusted to us by God.
- God gives different gifts and opportunities according to our ability.
- Faithful stewards take initiative and work diligently.
- Inaction is a form of disobedience.
- We will all give an account to Christ.
- Faithfulness now brings the Master’s approval: “Well done, good and faithful servant!”



HOW TO APPLY

- Identify the gifts, resources, and opportunities God has given you.
- Use them faithfully for His glory.
- Don’t let fear or comfort keep you from obedience.
- Be diligent in the ordinary things.
- Remember: the Master will return, and faithfulness matters.



*“Well done,
good and faithful servant!”*

Matthew 25:21

*Faithful stewardship
today prepares for
tomorrow’s rewards.*



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

*It’s not about how much
you have, but what you do
with what you’ve been given.*

*“Moreover, it is required of stewards
that they be found faithful.”*

1 CORINTHIANS 4:2

SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.

The Workers in the Vineyard

GOD'S GRACE DEFIES HUMAN EXPECTATIONS

The Kingdom is a gift, not a wage.



SCRIPTURE REFERENCE

Matthew 20:1–16



THE STORY

Jesus said, “For the kingdom of heaven is like a landowner who went out early in the morning to hire laborers for his vineyard... ‘Go into the vineyard also you, and whatever is right I will give you.’ So when evening came, the owner said to his foreman, ‘Call the laborers and pay them their wages, beginning with the last, up to the first.’ And when those hired about the eleventh hour came, each of them received a denarius. Now when those hired first came, they thought they would receive more, but each of them also received a denarius. And they grumbled... But he answered one of them, ‘Friend, I am doing you no wrong. Did you not agree with me for a denarius? Am I not allowed to do what I choose with what belongs to me? Or do you begrudge my generosity?’” (Matthew 20:1–16)

The landowner gives the same wage to all, reminding us that God’s grace is generous, not earned.



KEY LESSONS

- The Kingdom of God is a gift of grace, not a reward for merit.
- God’s generosity often challenges our sense of fairness.
- We all come to God by grace, whether early or late.
- Jealousy reveals a heart focused on what we think we deserve.
- God is free to give as He chooses, and His ways are higher than ours (Isaiah 55:8–9).



HOW TO APPLY

- Receive God’s grace with gratitude.
- Let go of comparisons and entitlement.
- Rejoice when others receive God’s blessings.
- Serve faithfully, not for reward, but out of love.
- Trust God’s wisdom and goodness, even when it surprises you.



*“The last will be first,
and the first will be last.”*

Matthew 20:16

*Grace changes
everything.*



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

*God’s grace is not fair —
it’s better than fair.*

*“For my thoughts are not your thoughts,
neither are your ways my ways, declares the LORD.”*

ISAIAH 55:8

SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.

The Two Sons

IT'S NOT ENOUGH TO SAY THE RIGHT THING.

True obedience is shown by what we do.



SCRIPTURE REFERENCE

Matthew 21:28–32



THE STORY

Jesus said, “What do you think? A man had two sons. He went to the first and said, ‘Son, go and work in the vineyard today.’ ‘I will not,’ he answered, but later he changed his mind and went.

Then the father went to the other son and said the same thing. He answered, ‘I will, sir,’ but he did not go.

Which of the two did what his father wanted?”

“The first,” they replied.

Jesus said to them, “Truly I tell you, the tax collectors and the prostitutes are entering the kingdom of God ahead of you. For John came to you to show you the way of righteousness, and you did not believe him, but the tax collectors and the prostitutes did. And even after you saw this, you did not repent and believe him.” (Matthew 21:28–32)



KEY LESSONS

- Actions reveal the true state of the heart.
- Repentance can come even after initial refusal.
- Religious words without obedience are empty.
- God welcomes the repentant, even those considered unlikely.
- The Kingdom belongs to those who trust and obey, not those who merely say they will.



HOW TO APPLY

- Examine whether your actions match your words.
- Be quick to repent and change course.
- Don't rely on outward religion or appearances.
- Welcome and encourage those who are turning to Christ.
- Choose obedience today — not just good intentions.



“The tax collectors and the prostitutes are entering the kingdom of God ahead of you.”

Matthew 21:31

Obedience is action, not words.



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

God is more interested in a changed heart than a correct answer.

“If you love me, you will keep my commandments.”

JOHN 14:15

SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.

The Rich Man and Lazarus

EARTHLY COMFORTS DON'T DEFINE ETERNAL REALITY.

What matters to God is often overlooked by the world.



SCRIPTURE REFERENCE

Luke 16:19–31



THE STORY

Jesus told this parable: “There was a rich man who was dressed in purple and fine linen and lived in luxury every day. At his gate was laid a beggar named Lazarus, covered with sores and longing to eat what fell from the rich man’s table. Even the dogs came and licked his sores.

The time came when the beggar died, and the angels carried him to Abraham’s side. The rich man also died and was buried.

In Hades, where he was in torment, he looked up and saw Abraham far away, with Lazarus at his side. ‘Father Abraham,’ he called out, ‘have mercy on me ... for I am in agony in this fire.’ Abraham replied, ‘Son, remember that in your lifetime you received your good things, while Lazarus received bad things, but now he is comforted here and you are in agony.’”

(Luke 16:19–25)

Jesus ended the parable with a warning: “If they do not listen to Moses and the Prophets, they will not be convinced even if someone rises from the dead.” (Luke 16:31)



KEY LESSONS

- Earthly wealth and comfort are temporary.
- God sees the overlooked and values the humble.
- There is real judgment and real eternal destinies.
- A hardened heart in this life can lead to eternal loss.
- Scripture is sufficient — we must listen now.



HOW TO APPLY

- Be faithful with what God has given.
- Notice and care for those in need.
- Examine your heart for indifference or pride.
- Take God’s Word seriously.
- Live with eternity in view, not just today’s comforts.



“And at his gate was laid a beggar named Lazarus...”

Luke 16:20

What you do with the least matters to the King.



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

This life is a test, not a reward.

“So we fix our eyes not on what is seen, but on what is unseen, for what is seen is temporary, but what is unseen is eternal.”

2 CORINTHIANS 4:18

SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.

The Fig Tree

A CALL TO FRUITFULNESS, NOT JUST APPEARANCE.

God looks for real fruit, not just religious leaves.



SCRIPTURE REFERENCE

Matthew 21:18–22
Mark 11:12–14, 20–25



THE STORY

Early in the morning, Jesus was hungry. Seeing a fig tree by the road, he went to it, but found nothing on it except leaves. He said to the tree, “May you never bear fruit again!” Immediately the tree withered.

The disciples were amazed. “How did the tree wither so quickly?” they asked.

Jesus replied, “Truly I tell you, if you have faith and do not doubt, not only can you do what was done to the fig tree, but you can also say to this mountain, ‘Go, throw yourself into the sea,’ and it will be done.” (Matthew 21:18–22)

(See also Mark 11:12–14, 20–25)



KEY LESSONS

- God desires fruit, not mere outward appearance.
- Religious profession without obedience is empty.
- Faith is real trust that acts, not just words.
- God has authority over all creation.
- True disciples bear the fruit of repentance, obedience, and love.



HOW TO APPLY

- Examine your life for real fruit.
- Don't be content with outward religion (going through the motions).
- Ask God for a heart that obeys, not just appears spiritual.
- Trust Jesus' authority and pray with faith.
- Be a person whose life points others to Christ through genuine fruit.



“May you never bear fruit again!”

Matthew 21:19

God looks beyond appearance to the heart.



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

Leaves may impress people, but fruit pleases God.

“By their fruit you will recognize them.”

MATTHEW 7:20

SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.

The Mustard Seed

SMALL BEGINNINGS, A GREAT KINGDOM.

God often grows his kingdom in unexpected ways.



SCRIPTURE REFERENCE

Matthew 13:31–32

Mark 4:30–32

Luke 13:18–19



THE STORY

Jesus said, “The kingdom of heaven is like a mustard seed, which a man took and sowed in his field. It is the smallest of all seeds, but when it has grown it is the largest of garden plants and becomes a tree, so that the birds of the air come and perch in its branches.”

(Matthew 13:31–32)

He said, “What shall we say the kingdom of God is like, or what parable shall we use to describe it? It is like a mustard seed, which is the smallest of all seeds on earth. Yet when planted, it grows and becomes the largest of all garden plants, with such big branches that the birds can perch in its shade.”

(Mark 4:30–32, Luke 13:18–19)



KEY LESSONS

- The kingdom often begins in humble, seemingly insignificant ways.
- God’s power, not our size, determines the outcome.
- The kingdom grows beyond human expectations.
- The result is a place of blessing for many (the birds).
- We are called to be faithful with small beginnings.



HOW TO APPLY

- Be faithful in the small things.
- Don’t despise a small start (Zechariah 4:10).
- Trust God to grow what you cannot.
- Look for opportunities to bless others as the kingdom expands.
- Stay planted in God’s Word and His mission.



“Though it is the smallest of all seeds, yet when it grows it is the largest of garden plants and becomes a tree.”

Matthew 13:32

Great things often grow from small beginnings.



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

God specializes in using little things to do big things.

“Do not despise these small beginnings, for the LORD rejoices to see the work begin.”

ZECHARIAH 4:10

SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.

The Yeast

A SMALL INFLUENCE THAT WORKS THROUGHOUT.

The Kingdom quietly transforms from within.



SCRIPTURE REFERENCE

Matthew 13:33
Luke 13:20–21
1 Corinthians 5:6–8



THE STORY

Jesus said, “The kingdom of heaven is like yeast that a woman took and mixed into about sixty pounds of flour until it worked all through the dough.” (Matthew 13:33)

Again he said, “What shall we say the kingdom of God is like? It is like yeast that a woman took and mixed into about thirty pounds of flour until it worked all through the dough.” (Luke 13:20–21)

Paul later used the same image to speak of godly influence: “A little yeast works through the whole batch of dough.” (1 Corinthians 5:6)



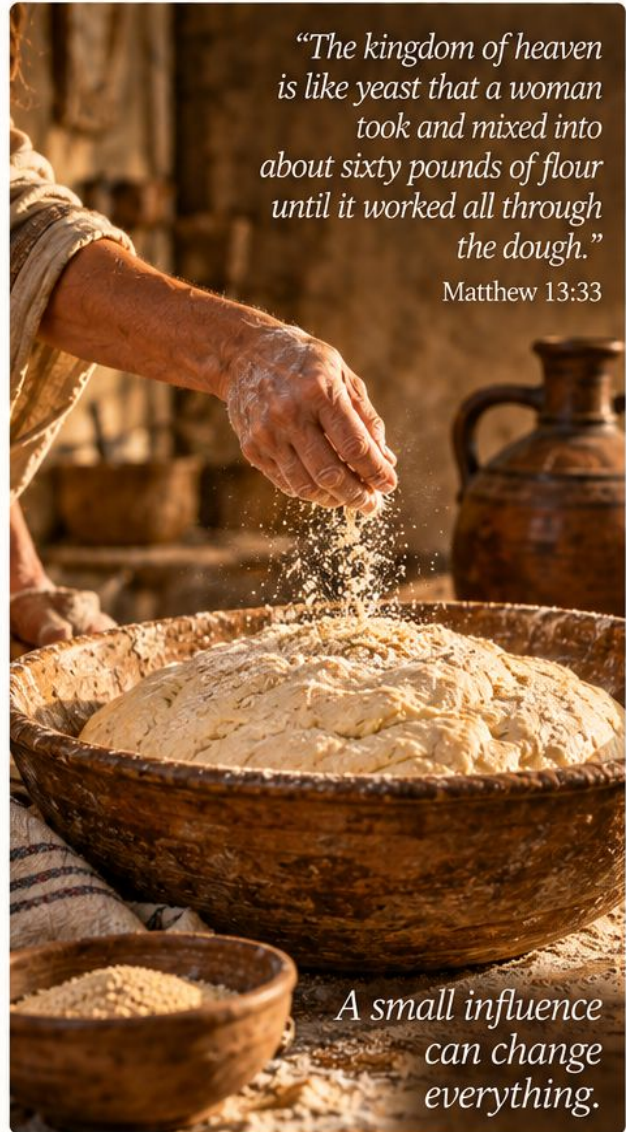
KEY LESSONS

- The Kingdom often spreads quietly, not through force, but through influence.
- Small, faithful obedience can have a far-reaching impact.
- The gospel changes hearts from within, producing real transformation.
- Both good and bad influences spread — we must guard what we allow into our lives.
- The Kingdom works in ordinary places: homes, workplaces, and communities.



HOW TO APPLY

- Be a positive, godly influence where you are.
- Don't underestimate small acts of obedience.
- Guard against harmful influences (sin and false teaching).
- Live consistently, knowing your life can affect others.
- Pray for the Kingdom to transform your family, church, and community from within.



“The kingdom of heaven is like yeast that a woman took and mixed into about sixty pounds of flour until it worked all through the dough.”

Matthew 13:33

A small influence can change everything.



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

Faithful, hidden influence often produces the greatest results.

“A little yeast works through the whole batch of dough.”

1 CORINTHIANS 5:6

SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.

The Persistent Widow

KEEP PRAYING. DON'T GIVE UP.

God hears and acts, even when it seems slow.



SCRIPTURE REFERENCE

Luke 18:1–8



THE STORY

Jesus told his disciples a parable to show them that they should always pray and not give up.

“There was a judge in a certain town who neither feared God nor cared what people thought. And there was a widow in that town who kept coming to him and saying, ‘Give me justice against my adversary.’

For a long time he refused. But finally he said to himself, ‘Even though I don’t fear God or care what people think, yet because this widow keeps bothering me, I will see that she gets justice, so that she won’t eventually come and attack me!’”

And the Lord said, “Listen to what the unrighteous judge says. And will not God bring about justice for his chosen ones, who cry out to him day and night? Will he keep putting them off? I tell you, he will see that they get justice, and quickly.”

(Luke 18:1–8)



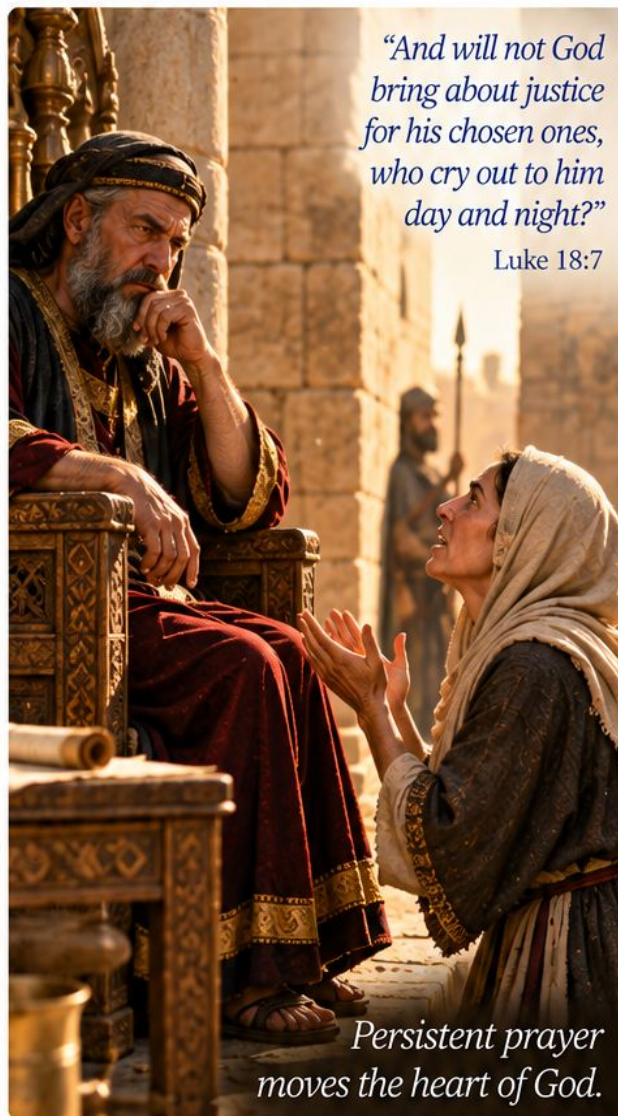
KEY LESSONS

- Jesus calls us to persistent, trusting prayer.
- God cares for his people and will do what is right.
- Delays are not denials.
- Persistence honors God and grows our faith.
- The unjust judge acted out of annoyance — how much more will a loving Father respond out of compassion?



HOW TO APPLY

- Keep praying, even when you don’t see immediate answers.
- Bring your needs, your church, and our culture before God regularly.
- Trust God’s timing and wisdom.
- Let persistent prayer shape a heart of dependence.
- Encourage others not to give up.



“And will not God bring about justice for his chosen ones, who cry out to him day and night?”

Luke 18:7

Persistent prayer moves the heart of God.



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

God may seem slow, but he is never indifferent. Keep praying.

“Let us not grow weary in doing good, for at the proper time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up.”

GALATIANS 6:9

SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.

The Pharisee and the Tax Collector

TRUE RIGHTEOUSNESS COMES FROM A HUMBLE HEART.

God justifies the humble, not the proud.



SCRIPTURE REFERENCE

Luke 18:9–14



THE STORY

Jesus told this parable to some who trusted in themselves that they were righteous, and treated others with contempt.

“Two men went up to the temple to pray, one a Pharisee and the other a tax collector. The Pharisee, standing by himself, prayed: ‘God, I thank you that I am not like other people — robbers, evildoers, adulterers — or even like this tax collector. I fast twice a week and give a tenth of all I get.’

But the tax collector, standing at a distance, would not even look up to heaven. Instead, he beat his breast and said, ‘God, have mercy on me, a sinner.’

Jesus said, “I tell you, this man, rather than the other, went home justified before God. For all those who exalt themselves will be humbled, and those who humble themselves will be exalted.” (Luke 18:9–14)



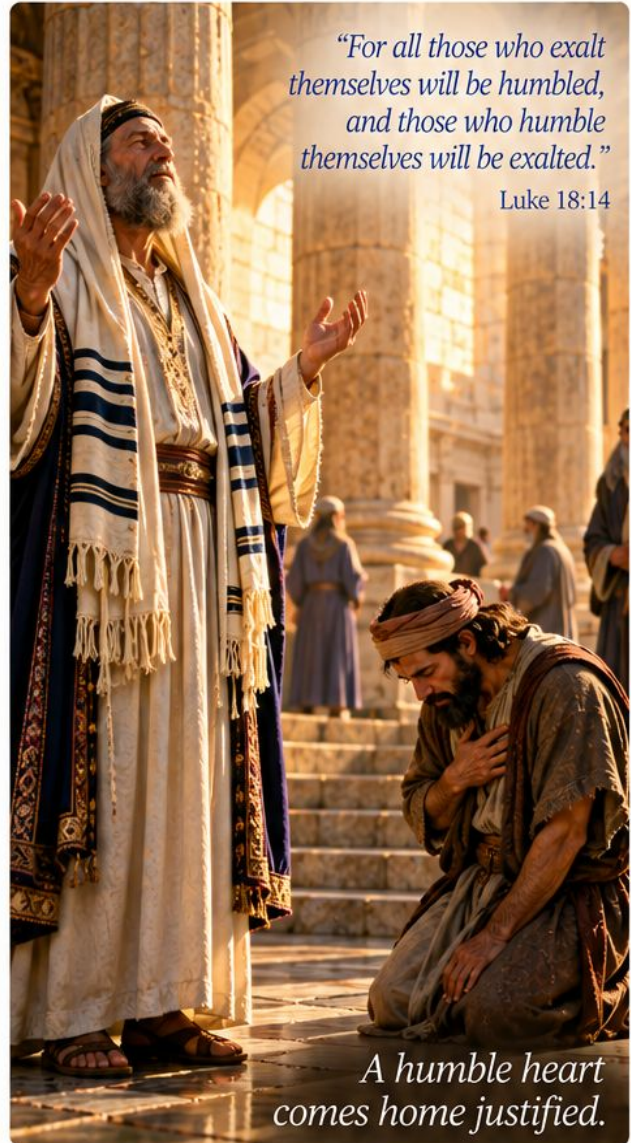
KEY LESSONS

- Self-righteousness blinds us to our need.
- God opposes pride but gives grace to the humble (James 4:6).
- True righteousness is received, not earned.
- A repentant heart is the right response to God’s holiness.
- We are all sinners in need of mercy (Romans 3:23).
- Humility leads to justification and a right relationship with God.



HOW TO APPLY

- Examine your heart for hidden pride.
- Confess your sin honestly and specifically.
- Stop comparing yourself to others.
- Rely on God’s mercy, not your performance.
- Cultivate a humble, grateful heart.
- Extend grace to others who struggle (as you do).



“For all those who exalt themselves will be humbled, and those who humble themselves will be exalted.”

Luke 18:14

A humble heart comes home justified.



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

God is not impressed with our performance, but our humility.

“Humble yourselves before the Lord, and he will exalt you.”

JAMES 4:10

SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.

The Rich Man and Lazarus

EARTHLY WEALTH IS TEMPORARY. ETERNAL REALITIES ARE NOT.

How we treat the least reveals what we truly value.



SCRIPTURE REFERENCE

Luke 16:19–31



THE STORY

Jesus told a parable about a rich man who lived in luxury, wearing fine clothes and feasting every day. At his gate lay a poor man named Lazarus, covered with sores, longing for what fell from the rich man's table. Even the dogs came and licked Lazarus's sores.

Both men died. Lazarus was carried by angels to be with Abraham. The rich man found himself in torment, begging for relief. He could see Lazarus in Abraham's arms and pleaded for someone to be sent to warn his brothers. But Abraham replied, "They have Moses and the Prophets; let them listen to them." The rich man said, "No, father Abraham, but if someone goes to them from the dead, they will repent." Abraham answered, "If they do not listen to Moses and the Prophets, they will not be convinced even if someone rises from the dead." (Luke 16:19–31)



KEY LESSONS

- Earthly wealth and comfort are temporary.
- God sees the poor and the overlooked.
- Our treatment of others reveals our true heart.
- After death, there is a real and irreversible judgment.
- God's Word is sufficient — we must listen now, not wait for a miracle.
- Eternal perspective changes how we live today.



HOW TO APPLY

- Be generous and compassionate to those in need.
- Don't let comfort make you blind to others.
- Take God's Word seriously — respond now.
- Examine your heart: What do you value most?
- Use the resources God has given you for eternal purposes.
- Live each day in light of eternity.



"Son, remember that you in your lifetime received your good things, and Lazarus in like manner bad things; but now he is comforted here, and you are in agony."

Luke 16:25

What we do with what we have matters to God.



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

Temporary treasures fade, but what we do for others echoes into eternity.

"Lay up for yourselves treasures in heaven, where moth and rust do not destroy."

MATTHEW 6:20

SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.

The Unforgiving Servant

GREAT FORGIVENESS LEADS TO A FORGIVING HEART.

Those who have been forgiven much must forgive others.



SCRIPTURE REFERENCE

Matthew 18:21–35



THE STORY

Peter asked Jesus, “Lord, how many times shall I forgive my brother when he sins against me? Up to seven times?”

Jesus answered, “I tell you, not seven times, but seventy-seven times.”

Then Jesus told a parable: A king forgave a servant a massive debt — ten thousand talents (an unimaginable sum). That same servant went out and grabbed a fellow servant who owed him a small debt — a hundred denarii — and demanded immediate payment. When the man could not pay, he threw him into prison. When the king heard what had happened, he was angry and had the unforgiving servant thrown into prison until he could pay the entire debt.

Jesus concluded, “So also my heavenly Father will do to every one of you, if you do not forgive your brother from your heart.” (Matthew 18:21–35)



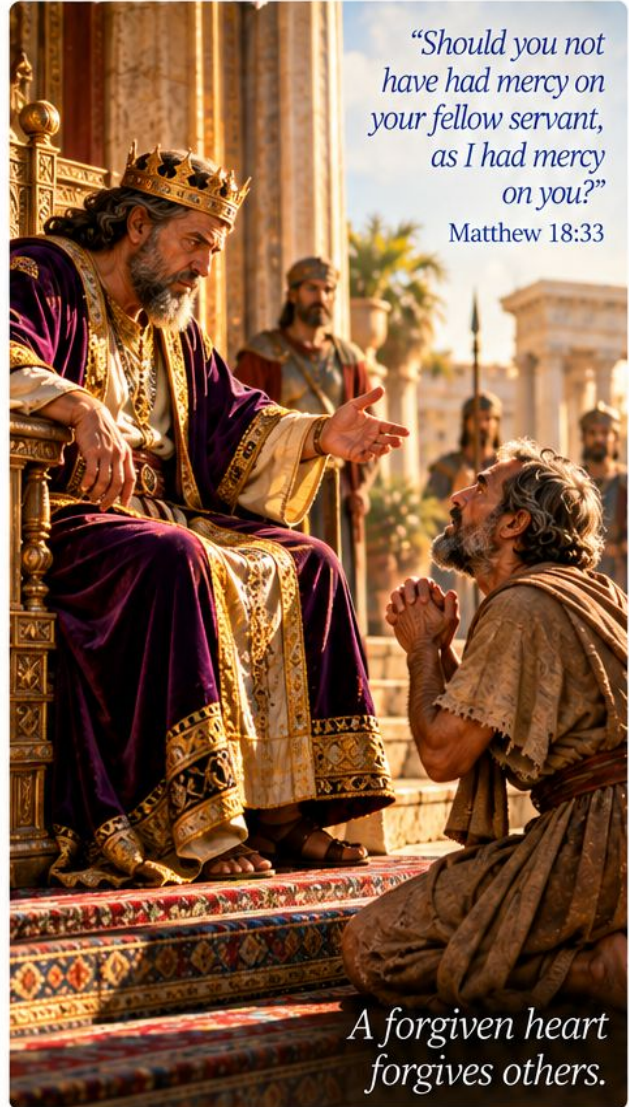
KEY LESSONS

- We have all been forgiven an immeasurable debt through Christ.
- In light of God’s mercy, we are called to forgive others — repeatedly and sincerely.
- Unforgiveness hardens the heart and disrupts the community.
- True forgiveness flows from a heart that remembers the gospel.
- God’s discipline for unforgiveness is real — and motivated by love.



HOW TO APPLY

- Remember how much God has forgiven you.
- Choose to forgive, even when it’s hard.
- Let go of bitterness; it poisons your own heart.
- Pursue reconciliation where possible.
- Ask God for a soft heart that reflects His grace to others.



“Should you not have had mercy on your fellow servant, as I had mercy on you?”

Matthew 18:33

A forgiven heart forgives others.



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

The measure of our forgiveness shows how well we understand God’s forgiveness.

“Be kind to one another, tenderhearted, forgiving one another, as God in Christ forgave you.”

EPHESIANS 4:32

SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.

The Workers in the Vineyard

GOD'S GRACE REDEFINES WHAT IS FAIR.

The Kingdom is a gift, not a wage.



SCRIPTURE REFERENCE

Matthew 20:1–16



THE STORY

Jesus told a parable about a landowner who went out early in the morning to hire workers for his vineyard, agreeing to pay them a denarius for the day.

He went out again at the third hour, the sixth hour, the ninth hour, and even the eleventh hour, hiring more workers.

At the end of the day, the landowner told his foreman to pay everyone, starting with those hired last. To their surprise, each worker — even those who worked only one hour — received a full denarius.

Those who worked all day grumbled, saying, “These last worked only one hour, and you have made them equal to us!”

The landowner answered, “Friend, I am not doing you wrong. Did you not agree with me for a denarius? Am I not free to do what I wish with what belongs to me? Or are you envious because I am generous?” (Matthew 20:1–16)



KEY LESSONS

- God's grace is generous, not transactional.
- The Kingdom is received by grace, not earned by effort.
- Envy reveals a heart focused on comparison rather than gratitude.
- God is free to show mercy however he chooses.
- There is great joy in working in God's Kingdom at any time — early or late.



HOW TO APPLY

- Receive God's grace with gratitude.
- Stop comparing your spiritual journey with others.
- Serve faithfully, no matter when God calls you.
- Celebrate God's mercy toward others.
- Live with a generous heart, reflecting the King's kindness.



“Are you envious because I am generous?”

Matthew 20:15

Grace gives what we do not deserve — and that changes everything.



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

God's grace is not measured by our work, but by his generosity.

“For by grace you have been saved through faith. And this is not your own doing; it is the gift of God.”

EPHESIANS 2:8

SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.

The Good Samaritan

LOVE CROSSES BOUNDARIES.

True neighbor love shows itself in action.



SCRIPTURE REFERENCE

Luke 10:25–37



THE STORY

A lawyer asked Jesus, “Teacher, what must I do to inherit eternal life?” Jesus answered, “What is written in the Law? How do you read it?” The lawyer replied, “Love the Lord your God with all your heart... and love your neighbor as yourself.”

But wanting to justify himself, he asked, “And who is my neighbor?”

Jesus told a parable: A man was going down from Jerusalem to Jericho when he was attacked by robbers, left beaten and half dead. A priest came by, but passed on the other side. Then a Levite came, but also passed by.

But a Samaritan — a man from a despised group — stopped, had compassion, bandaged his wounds, put him on his own animal, took him to an inn, and paid for his care.

Then Jesus asked, “Which of these three proved to be a neighbor to the man who fell into the hands of robbers?” The lawyer replied, “The one who showed him mercy.”

Jesus said, “Go and do likewise.” (Luke 10:25–37)



KEY LESSONS

- True neighbor love is shown by action, not words.
- Compassion crosses ethnic, social, and religious boundaries.
- Religious activity without mercy misses the heart of God’s law.
- Our neighbor is anyone in need, not just those like us.
- Love is costly, inconvenient, and practical.



HOW TO APPLY

- Look for opportunities to serve those in need.
- Overcome indifference and prejudice.
- Be willing to interrupt your plans to help others.
- Show compassion in tangible ways.
- Ask God to give you a heart that sees people as he sees them.



“Go and do likewise.”

Luke 10:37

*Compassion
sees a need
and stops.*



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

*A true neighbor
is a person in need,
not a person like me.*

“Whoever loves his neighbor has fulfilled the law.”

ROMANS 13:8

SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.

The Persistent Widow

KEEP PRAYING. GOD HEARS.

Persistent prayer reflects trusting faith.



SCRIPTURE REFERENCE

Luke 18:1–8



THE STORY

Jesus told a parable about a widow who kept coming to an unjust judge, asking for justice against her adversary.

For a long time, the judge refused. But the widow kept coming, saying, “Give me justice against my adversary!”

Finally, the judge said to himself, “Though I do not fear God or respect man, yet because this widow keeps bothering me, I will give her justice, so that she will not go on striking me!”

Then the Lord said, “Hear what the unjust judge says. And will not God give justice to his elect, who cry to him day and night? Will he delay long over them?”

I tell you, he will give justice to them speedily. Nevertheless, when the Son of Man comes, will he find faith on earth?” (Luke 18:1–8)



KEY LESSONS

- Persistent prayer honors God and expresses faith.
- God is just and hears the cries of his people (Psalm 34:17).
- Delay is not denial — God’s timing is perfect (2 Peter 3:9).
- Prayer keeps us dependent on God, not self.
- Jesus is looking for faith when he returns.



HOW TO APPLY

- Keep praying, even when you don’t see immediate answers.
- Bring your real needs, big and small, to God.
- Trust God’s character, not your circumstances.
- Let prayer shape a life of faith and endurance.
- Encourage others to persevere in prayer.



“And will not God give justice to his elect, who cry to him day and night? Will he delay long over them?”

Luke 18:7

Faith keeps asking, even when the answer takes time.



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

God’s timing is not God’s ignoring.

“He will give justice to his elect, who cry to him day and night.”

LUKE 18:7

SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.

The Pharisee and the Tax Collector

HUMILITY OPENS THE DOOR TO GRACE.

God exalts the humble, not the self-righteous.



SCRIPTURE REFERENCE

Luke 18:9–14



THE STORY

Jesus told a parable to some who trusted in themselves that they were righteous and looked down on others.

Two men went up to the temple to pray — a Pharisee and a tax collector.

The Pharisee stood by himself and prayed, “God, I thank you that I am not like other people — thieves, evildoers, adulterers — or even like this tax collector. I fast twice a week and give a tenth of all I get.”

But the tax collector stood at a distance. He would not even look up to heaven, but beat his chest and said, “God, have mercy on me, a sinner.”

Jesus said, “I tell you, this man, rather than the other, went home justified before God. For everyone who exalts himself will be humbled, and the one who humbles himself will be exalted.”

(Luke 18:9–14)



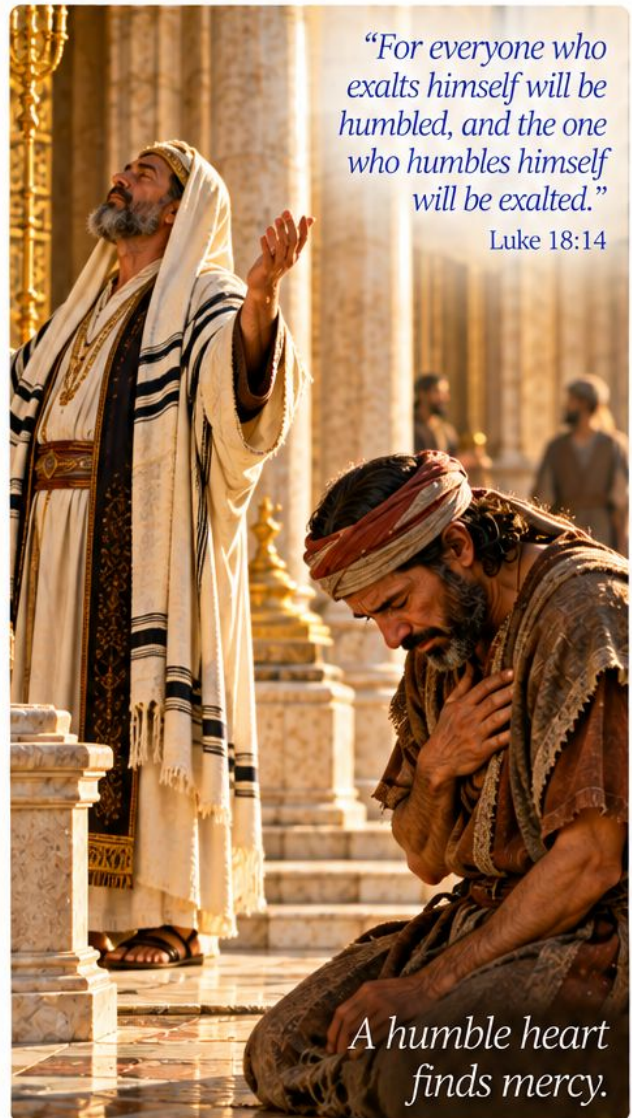
KEY LESSONS

- Self-righteousness blinds; humility sees a need for grace.
- External religion is not the same as a right heart.
- God justifies the humble who repent.
- Comparison with others is a danger.
- True prayer is honest, not performative.



HOW TO APPLY

- Examine your own heart for hidden pride.
- Confess your sin honestly to God.
- Resist the temptation to look down on others.
- Trust God’s mercy, not your own goodness.
- Live with a humble heart in everyday life.



“For everyone who exalts himself will be humbled, and the one who humbles himself will be exalted.”

Luke 18:14

A humble heart finds mercy.



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

God resists the proud, but gives grace to the humble.

James 4:6

“Humble yourselves before the Lord, and he will exalt you.”

JAMES 4:10

SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.

The Two Sons

OBEDIENCE MATTERS MORE THAN WORDS.

True repentance is shown by what we do.



SCRIPTURE REFERENCE

Matthew 21:28–32



THE STORY

Jesus told a parable about a man who had two sons. He went to the first son and said, “Son, go and work in the vineyard today.”

The first son answered, “I will not,” but later he changed his mind and went.

Then the father went to the second son and said the same thing. The second son answered, “I will, sir,” but he did not go.

Jesus asked, “Which of the two did the will of his father?”

They said, “The first.”

Jesus said, “Truly I tell you, the tax collectors and the prostitutes are entering the kingdom of God ahead of you. For John came to you to show you the way of righteousness, and you did not believe him, but the tax collectors and the prostitutes did. And even after you saw this, you did not later change your minds and believe him.”

(Matthew 21:28–32)



KEY LESSONS

- Actions reveal true repentance.
- Saying the right thing is not the same as doing the right thing.
- God values changed hearts that bear fruit.
- Those once far from God can respond in faith, while religious insiders can harden their hearts.
- The Kingdom is entered by genuine faith that leads to obedience.



HOW TO APPLY

- Let your actions match your words.
- Don't settle for empty promises to God.
- Be ready to change your mind and obey.
- Examine whether you are doing the Father's will or just talking about it.
- Encourage others by your faithful actions.



“It is not those who say to me, ‘Lord, Lord,’ but those who do the will of my Father in heaven.”

Matthew 7:21

Obedience proves what we truly believe.



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

True obedience is the fruit of a changed heart.

“By this we know that we love the children of God, when we love God and keep his commandments.”

1 JOHN 5:2

SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.

The Talents

FAITHFUL STEWARDS MAKE A DIFFERENCE.

What we do with what we're given matters.



SCRIPTURE REFERENCE

Matthew 25:14–30



THE STORY

Jesus told a parable about a man who went on a journey. He called his servants and entrusted his wealth to them — to one he gave five talents, to another two, and to another one, each according to his ability. Then he went away.

The servant with five talents went at once and put his money to work and gained five more. The servant with two talents did the same and gained two more.

But the servant with one talent went and hid his master's money in the ground. After a long time, the master returned and settled accounts. The first two servants were praised: "Well done, good and faithful servant! You have been faithful with a few things; I will put you in charge of many things. Come and share your master's happiness!" But the third servant was rebuked for his fear and unbelief, and the talent was given to the one who had ten.

(Matthew 25:14–30)



KEY LESSONS

- God gives each person gifts and opportunities according to his wisdom.
- We are stewards, not owners, of what God provides.
- Faithfulness is more important than the amount given.
- Doing nothing is a choice — and it has consequences.
- Eternal reward is given to those who are faithful with what they have.



HOW TO APPLY

- Identify the gifts, resources, and opportunities God has given you.
- Put what you have to work for his glory.
- Don't let fear or complacency keep you from acting.
- Be faithful in small things.
- Ask God for wisdom to be a good steward.



"Well done, good and faithful servant!"

Matthew 25:21

Faithful stewardship today prepares us for greater responsibility tomorrow.



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

Faithfulness with what we have today leads to more tomorrow.

"Moreover, it is required of stewards that they be found faithful."

1 CORINTHIANS 4:2

SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.

The Sheep and the Goats

TRUE FAITH SHOWS ITSELF IN COMPASSION.

What we do for the least, we do for the King.



SCRIPTURE REFERENCE

Matthew 25:31–46



THE STORY

Jesus told a parable about the Son of Man coming in his glory with all the angels. He will sit on his glorious throne, and all the nations will be gathered before him. He will separate the people as a shepherd separates the sheep from the goats.

To those on his right, the sheep, he will say, “Come, you who are blessed by my Father... for I was hungry and you gave me food, I was thirsty and you gave me drink, I was a stranger and you welcomed me, I was naked and you clothed me, I was sick and you visited me, I was in prison and you came to me.”

The righteous will ask, “Lord, when did we see you...?” And he will answer, “Truly I tell you, whatever you did for one of the least of these brothers and sisters of mine, you did for me.”

Then he will say to those on his left, the goats, “Depart from me... for I was hungry and you gave me no food...” (Matthew 25:31–46)



KEY LESSONS

- True faith produces love in practical ways.
- How we treat the least reflects our love for Christ.
- People are not saved by good works, but genuine faith always bears fruit in love and compassion.
- Every person has eternal significance.
- We will give an account for how we treated others.

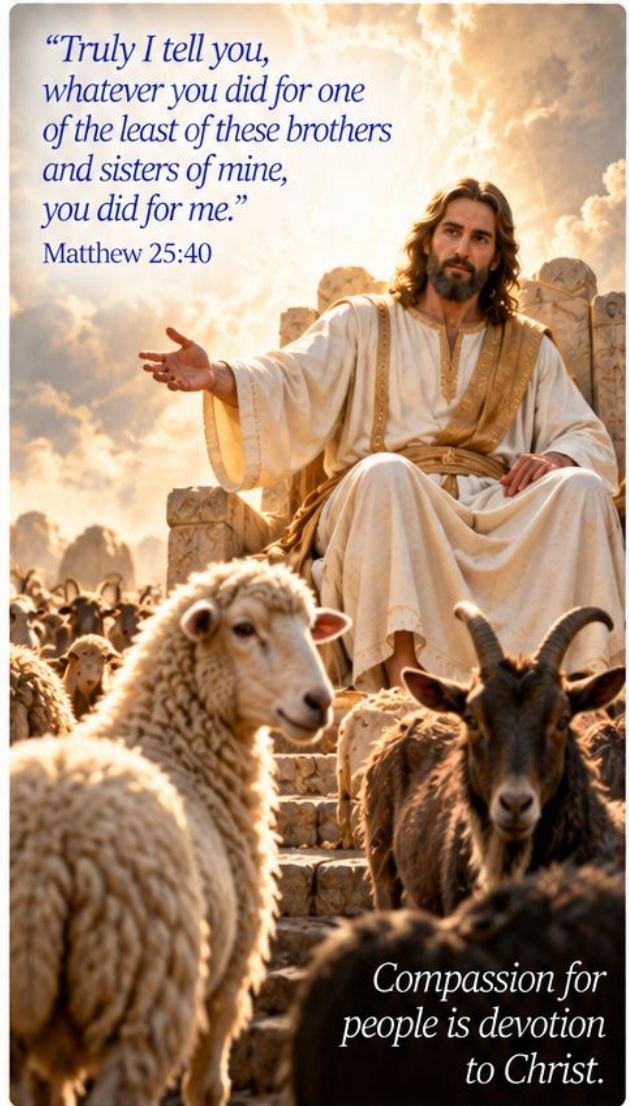


HOW TO APPLY

- Look for real opportunities to serve people in need.
- Treat others with dignity, especially the overlooked.
- Ask God to give you a heart of compassion.
- Let your love for Christ move from words to action.
- Be faithful in small acts of kindness.

*“Truly I tell you,
whatever you did for one
of the least of these brothers
and sisters of mine,
you did for me.”*

Matthew 25:40



*Compassion for
people is devotion
to Christ.*



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

*How we treat the least
shows who we truly
serve.*

*“As you did it to one of the least of these my brothers and sisters,
you did it to me.”*

MATTHEW 25:40

SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.

The Unforgiving Servant

GOD'S FORGIVENESS CALLS US TO FORGIVE OTHERS.

We can't keep what we've been freely given.



SCRIPTURE REFERENCE

Matthew 18:21–35



THE STORY

Peter came to Jesus and asked, “Lord, how many times shall I forgive my brother when he sins against me? Up to seven times?”

Jesus said, “I do not say to you seven times, but seventy-seven times.”

Then Jesus told a parable about a king who wanted to settle accounts with his servants. One servant owed him a huge debt — ten thousand talents — an amount he could never repay. The servant begged, “Have patience with me, and I will pay you everything.”

The king was moved with compassion and forgave the entire debt.

But that same servant later found a fellow servant who owed him a small debt. He demanded payment and threw the man in prison when he could not pay.

When the king heard about this, he was angry and sent the unforgiving servant to prison, saying, “Should you not have had mercy on your fellow servant, as I had mercy on you?”

Then Jesus concluded, “So also my heavenly Father will do to every one of you, if you do not forgive your brother from your heart.” (Matthew 18:21–35)



KEY LESSONS

- God's forgiveness is lavish and undeserved.
- Forgiveness is not optional for followers of Christ.
- Holding a grudge contradicts the gospel.
- Our response to others shows whether we truly understand God's mercy.
- Unforgiveness brings spiritual and relational destruction.



HOW TO APPLY

- Remember how much God has forgiven you.
- Choose to forgive, even when it's hard.
- Let go of bitterness and bring it to Christ.
- Seek reconciliation where possible.
- Make a habit of grace in your relationships.



“So also my heavenly Father will do to every one of you, if you do not forgive your brother from your heart.”

Matthew 18:35

We have been forgiven much, so we must forgive others.



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

Forgiveness reflects a heart that has been forgiven.

“Be kind and compassionate to one another, forgiving each other, just as in Christ God forgave you.”

EPHESIANS 4:32

SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.

The Prodigal Son

A FATHER'S HEART REVEALS GOD'S AMAZING GRACE.

No one who genuinely returns to God is ever too far gone.



SCRIPTURE REFERENCE

Luke 15:11–32



THE STORY

Jesus told a parable about a man who had two sons. The younger son asked for his inheritance, left home, and wasted everything in a distant country through reckless living. When he finally came to his senses, he said, "I will get up and go to my father and say, 'Father, I have sinned against heaven and before you. I am no longer worthy to be called your son.'"

While he was still a long way off, his father saw him, ran to him, and embraced him. The son confessed his sin, but the father restored him fully — a robe, a ring, and a feast — celebrating his return.

Meanwhile, the older son was angry and refused to join the celebration. The father explained, "Your brother was dead and is alive again; he was lost and is found."

(Luke 15:11–32)



KEY LESSONS

- God welcomes sincere repentance.
- Grace is greater than our sin.
- The father's love is active, pursuing, and restoring.
- Religious self-righteousness can miss the heart of God.
- True joy in God includes rejoicing when others are restored.



HOW TO APPLY

- Come to God honestly — no excuses.
- Receive his forgiveness by faith.
- Live as a beloved child, not a hired servant.
- Avoid a critical or resentful spirit toward others.
- Celebrate when others turn to God.



"But while he was still a long way off, his father saw him and had compassion, and ran and embraced him and kissed him."

Luke 15:20

Grace runs toward us, even when we've run away.



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

God's grace doesn't wait for us to be worthy — only willing.

"For this my son was dead, and is alive again; he was lost, and is found."

LUKE 15:24

SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.

The Rich Man and Lazarus

EARTHLY COMFORTS CANNOT BUY ETERNAL SECURITY.

What we do with what we have matters forever.



SCRIPTURE REFERENCE

Luke 16:19–31



THE STORY

Jesus told a parable about a rich man who lived in luxury, wearing fine clothes and feasting every day. At his gate lay Lazarus, a poor man, covered with sores, longing for the scraps from the rich man's table, but no one gave him anything.

Both men died. Lazarus was carried by angels to Abraham's side, while the rich man was buried and found himself in torment in Hades.

In anguish, the rich man looked up and saw Lazarus in comfort. He begged Abraham to send Lazarus to warn his family, but Abraham replied, "They have Moses and the Prophets; let them listen to them."

The rich man insisted, but Abraham said, "If they do not listen to Moses and the Prophets, neither will they be convinced even if someone rises from the dead."

(Luke 16:19–31)



KEY LESSONS

- Material wealth is not a sign of God's favor.
- Indifference to the suffering of others reveals a hard heart.
- Death ends the time for repentance.
- God's Word is sufficient to reveal the truth.
- Eternal realities are more important than earthly comfort.



HOW TO APPLY

- Use what God has given you to bless others.
- Don't become insensitive to the needs around you.
- Take God's Word seriously — today.
- Examine your heart: are you trusting in riches or in Christ?
- Live with eternity in view.



"They have Moses and the Prophets; let them listen to them."

Luke 16:29

Earthly riches fade, but what we do with them echoes forever.



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

It's not what we have, but what we do with it, that matters to God.

"For what does it profit a man if he gains the whole world and loses or forfeits himself?"

LUKE 9:25

SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.

The Great Banquet

GOD'S INVITATION GOES WIDER THAN WE EXPECT.
The kingdom is open to all, but not everyone accepts the invitation.



SCRIPTURE REFERENCE

Luke 14:15–24



THE STORY

Jesus told a parable about a man who prepared a great banquet and invited many guests. When the time came, he sent his servant to tell those who were invited, "Come, for everything is now ready."

But one by one they all began to make excuses. One said, "I have bought a field, and I must go and see it." Another said, "I have bought five oxen, and I am going to test them." Another said, "I have married a wife, and therefore I cannot come."

The servant returned and reported this to his master. The master was angry and said, "Go out quickly to the streets and alleys of the town and bring in the poor and crippled and blind and lame." The servant did so, and still there was room.

Then the master said, "Go out to the highways and hedges and compel people to come in, that my house may be filled. For I tell you, none of those men who were invited shall taste my banquet."

(Luke 14:15–24)



KEY LESSONS

- God's grace is generous and far-reaching.
- Excuses reveal what we truly value.
- The invitation of the kingdom includes the outcasts, not just the insiders.
- There is urgency — the time is now.
- Rejecting God's invitation has real consequences.



HOW TO APPLY

- Examine what keeps you from saying "yes" to God.
- Don't let good things become ultimate things.
- Look for opportunities to invite others.
- Be willing to reach out to those on the margins.
- Respond today — the invitation is still open.



"Go out to the highways and hedges and compel people to come in, that my house may be filled."

Luke 14:23

The King's table has room for more.



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

God's invitation is gracious, but a response is required.

"Many are invited, but few are chosen."

MATTHEW 22:14

SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.

The Ten Minas

FAITHFUL STEWARDS WORK WHILE THE KING IS AWAY.

The question is not what we have, but what we do with what we've been given.



SCRIPTURE REFERENCE

Luke 19:11–27



THE STORY

Jesus told a parable because he was near Jerusalem and the people thought the kingdom of God would appear immediately.

A nobleman went to a distant country to receive a kingdom and then return. Before he left, he called ten servants and gave each one mina (a large sum of money), telling them, “Do business until I come back.”

When he returned, he called the servants to give an account. The first servant had doubled his mina and was commended: “Well done, good servant!” The second had also doubled his and received the same praise. But the third had done nothing, keeping the mina hidden in a cloth. The master rebuked him, “For I will judge you by your own words... why then did you not put my money in the bank, so that at my coming I might have collected it with interest?”

The master took the mina from the unfaithful servant and gave it to the one with ten minas, then said, “Bring here those my enemies who did not want me to reign over them, and kill them before me.” (Luke 19:11–27)



KEY LESSONS

- God entrusts real responsibility to his people.
- Faithfulness, not perfection, is what matters.
- Inaction is also a decision — and it has consequences.
- We will give an account for how we use what God has given us.
- The return of Christ is certain, and he will reign.



HOW TO APPLY

- Use your gifts, time, and resources for God's glory.
- Look for opportunities to “do business” for the King.
- Don't bury what God has entrusted to you.
- Be faithful in the small things.
- Live each day with the reality of Christ's return.



*“Well done,
good servant!”*

Luke 19:17

*Faithful use
of what God gives
today matters
in the kingdom tomorrow.*



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

*We are stewards
today because the
King is coming back
tomorrow.*

“It is required of stewards that they be found faithful.”

1 CORINTHIANS 4:2

SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.

The Obedient Servant

FAITHFULNESS MEANS DOING WHAT WE ARE CALLED TO DO.

We are unworthy servants — we simply do our duty.



SCRIPTURE REFERENCE

Luke 17:7–10



THE STORY

Jesus told his disciples, “Which of you, having a servant plowing or keeping sheep, will say to him when he has come in from the field, ‘Come at once and recline at table’?”

Will he not rather say to him, ‘Prepare supper for me, and dress properly, and serve me while I eat and drink, and afterward you will eat and drink’?”

Does he thank the servant because he did what was commanded? So you also, when you have done all that you were commanded, say, ‘We are unworthy servants; we have only done what was our duty.’”

(Luke 17:7–10)



KEY LESSONS

- God’s people are called to faithful obedience, not recognition.
- Doing what we are commanded is our duty, not a reason for pride.
- We are servants, not owners, of what God has given us.
- Faithfulness matters, even when it goes unnoticed.



HOW TO APPLY

- Do your work for the Lord, not for applause.
- Serve faithfully in the ordinary, everyday tasks.
- Avoid entitlement — we are stewards, not owners.
- Cultivate a humble heart: “I have done what I was supposed to do.”
- Keep serving, even when no one says “thank you.”



“We are unworthy servants; we have only done what was our duty.”

Luke 17:10

Faithful service matters to the King, even when it goes unnoticed.



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

Obedience is not a way to earn God’s favor — it is the joyful duty of his servants.

“Whatever you do, work heartily, as for the Lord and not for men.”

COLOSSIANS 3:23

SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.

The Persistent Widow

KEEP PRAYING — GOD WILL BRING JUSTICE.

True faith keeps coming, even when the answer seems delayed.



SCRIPTURE REFERENCE

Luke 18:1–8



THE STORY

Jesus told his disciples a parable about a widow who kept coming to an unjust judge, saying, “Give me justice against my adversary.”

For a long time the judge refused, but finally he said to himself, “Though I fear not God, nor regard man, yet because this widow keeps bothering me, I will give her justice, so that she will not wear me out with her pleas.”

Then the Lord said, “Hear what the unrighteous judge says. And will not God bring about justice for his elect, who cry to him day and night? Will he delay long over them? I tell you, he will bring justice for them speedily. Nevertheless, when the Son of Man comes, will he find faith on earth?” (Luke 18:1–8)



KEY LESSONS

- We are to pray always and not give up.
- God is just and hears the cries of his people.
- Delay is not denial — God’s timing is perfect.
- Persistent prayer reflects genuine faith.
- Jesus will return, and the question is: Will he find faith on earth?



HOW TO APPLY

- Keep praying, even when you don’t see immediate answers.
- Bring your burdens, big and small, to God.
- Trust that God is working, even in silence.
- Pray with faith, not doubt, expecting God to act.
- Encourage others to persevere in prayer.



“Give me justice against my adversary!”

Luke 18:3

Persistent prayer honors a just God and displays a living faith.



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

God may delay, but he does not forget. Keep praying.

“Pray without ceasing.”
1 THESSALONIANS 5:17

SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.

The Pharisee and the Tax Collector

HUMILITY OPENS THE DOOR TO GOD'S GRACE.

God resists the proud, but gives grace to the humble.



SCRIPTURE REFERENCE

Luke 18:9–14



THE STORY

Jesus told this parable to some who trusted in their own righteousness and looked down on others.

Two men went up to the temple to pray — a Pharisee and a tax collector. The Pharisee stood by himself and prayed, “God, I thank you that I am not like other people — thieves, wrongdoers, adulterers — or even like this tax collector. I fast twice a week and give a tenth of all I get.”

But the tax collector stood at a distance. He would not even look up to heaven, but beat his breast and said, “God, have mercy on me, a sinner.”

Jesus said, “I tell you, this man, rather than the other, went home justified before God. For all those who exalt themselves will be humbled, and those who humble themselves will be exalted.” (Luke 18:9–14)



KEY LESSONS

- Self-righteousness blinds us to our need for grace.
- True repentance is humble and honest.
- God justifies sinners, not the self-righteous.
- Outward religion is not enough — God looks at the heart.
- Humility leads to exaltation in God's time.



HOW TO APPLY

- Examine your own heart for hidden pride.
- Confess your sin honestly to God.
- Stop comparing yourself to others.
- Trust in God's mercy, not your own performance.
- Cultivate a humble spirit in prayer and in daily life.



“For all those who exalt themselves will be humbled, and those who humble themselves will be exalted.”

Luke 18:14

God sees the heart, not the appearance.



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

A humble heart finds mercy, while a proud heart walks away empty.

“God opposes the proud, but gives grace to the humble.”

JAMES 4:6

SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.

The Ten Minas

BE FAITHFUL UNTIL THE KING RETURNS.

Our time, talents, and resources are entrusted to us for the Kingdom.



SCRIPTURE REFERENCE

Luke 19:11–27



THE STORY

Jesus told this parable because some thought the kingdom of God would appear immediately. A nobleman went to a far country to receive a kingdom and then return.

He called ten of his servants and gave them each a mina, saying, “Do business with this until I come back.”

When he returned, he found that one servant had gained ten minas, another five, and another had kept his mina in a cloth, doing nothing.

The nobleman commended the first two servants with these words: “Well done, good servant! You have been faithful in a very little; have authority over ten cities” (and over five cities).

But to the one who did nothing, he said, “You wicked servant! You knew that I was a hard man... Why then did you not put my money in the bank, and at my coming I might have collected it with interest?”

Then he said, “But as for these enemies of mine who did not want me to reign over them, bring them here and slaughter them before me.”

(Luke 19:11–27)



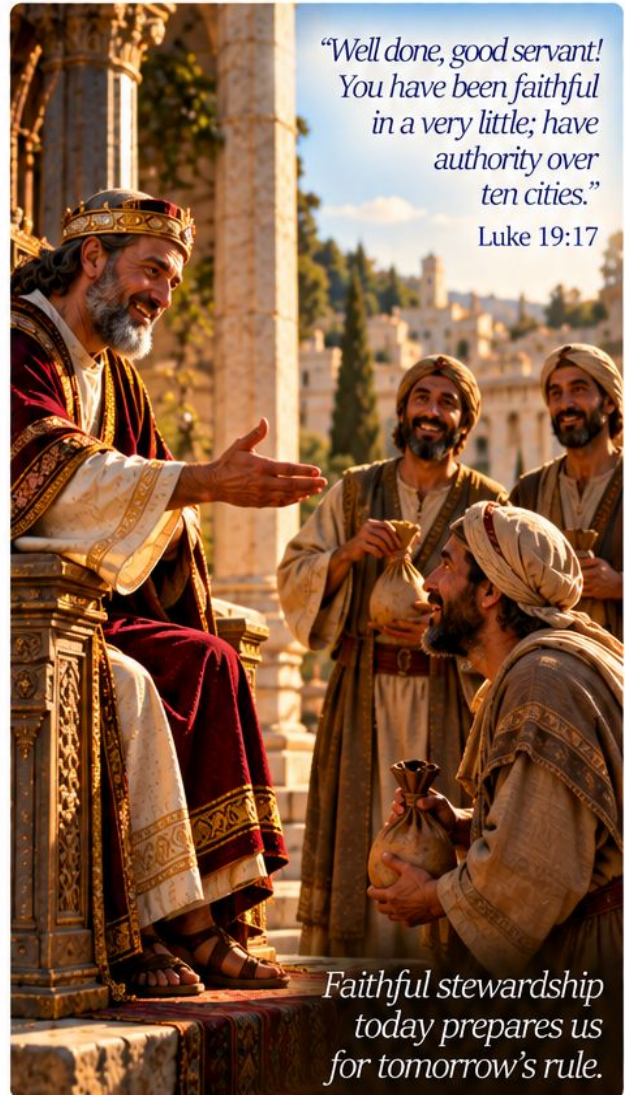
KEY LESSONS

- Jesus will return, and we will give an account.
- We are entrusted with what belongs to the King.
- Faithfulness in small things leads to greater responsibility.
- Doing nothing is a choice — and it has consequences.
- Some actively resist Christ’s reign; the King’s return will bring justice.



HOW TO APPLY

- Use your time, talents, and resources for the Kingdom.
- Look for opportunities to serve and invest for Christ’s glory.
- Avoid passivity — doing nothing is not neutral.
- Be faithful in ordinary responsibilities.
- Live with an eternal perspective, ready for his return.



*“Well done, good servant!
You have been faithful
in a very little; have
authority over
ten cities.”*

Luke 19:17

*Faithful stewardship
today prepares us
for tomorrow’s rule.*



A THOUGHT TO REMEMBER

*The King will return.
What we do with
what he has given us
matters.*

“Occupy until I come.”

LUKE 19:13

SAME
TRUTH.
DEEPER
ROOTS.
BRIGHTER
LIVES.